

SYMBOLS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

TEXT: John 16:7-14 (KJV) *“I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you. ⁸ And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment: ⁹ Of sin, because they believe not on me; ¹⁰ Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more; ¹¹ Of judgment, because the prince of this world is judged. ¹² I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now. ¹³ Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come. ¹⁴ He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.”*

INTRO: One of the greatest hurdles for individuals who are seeking to discover more about the Holy Spirit is being able to grasp who He is.

So important is the person and work of Holy Spirit that the Bible is only one verse old before He is mentioned. Genesis 1:2 (KJV) *“And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.”*

One of the greatest hindrances to our culture being able to fully embrace the person of the Holy Spirit is the fact that He is called the *“Holy Ghost or Holy Spirit.”* When we hear these terms, all of a sudden we seem to leap-frog to something strange or mystical and nothing could be further from the truth.

The Holy Ghost or Holy Spirit is nothing to be afraid of, in fact He is a person who

should be closely embraced by every single believer.

Some of the problem is that He is a person without a body and that seems odd to us because:

- We are made in the image of God, therefore we know He has a body...
- Jesus donned an earth suit and became Immanuel, God with us...

But Holy Spirit? For some, Holy Spirit is incomprehensible. Tonight, I would like to flesh out for us, who Holy Spirit really is.

Scattered throughout Scripture are several key symbols of the Spirit. If He in fact has no body, at least He does manifest Himself in visible forms called symbols. These symbols will help us understand:

- Who He is...
- What He does...
- How we can interact with Him

I. DOVE...

The word dove is mentioned more than fifty times in the Bible.

Noah's dove brought back the welcomed news that the wrath of God had subsided, and the peace of God had been enacted. From that moment, the dove has been viewed as a symbol of peace. If we need peace, we need to reconnect with the symbol of peace: Holy Spirit brings peace.

In the New Testament, Holy Spirit presents as a Dove. Luke 3:21-22 (KJV) *“Now when all the people were baptized, it came to pass, that Jesus also being baptized, and praying, the heaven was opened, 22 And the Holy Ghost descended in a bodily shape like a dove upon him, and a voice came from heaven, which said, Thou art my beloved Son; in thee I am well pleased.”*

When Holy Spirit descends upon us, we not only will experience peace, but we will also become peaceful. (Meanest and Nicest people)

I believe Holy Spirit descending on Jesus in the form of a dove was symbolic not only of the baptism of Jesus in water, but also of His baptism in Holy Spirit. It wasn't until after His Baptism that Jesus began to perform miracles. ***“You will do greater things because I will go to My Father and He will send Holy Spirit to abide in you.”***

II. WIND...

The first outpouring of Holy Spirit in the New Testament marks the birthday of the New Testament Church in Acts chapter two. Happy Birthday, Y'all!

In this initial outpouring, two symbols of the Spirit are enacted: wind and fire.

Wind represents sovereignty. Sovereignty

means one who exercises supreme power.
One who is sovereign can do:

- What he wants to...
- When he wants to...
- Where he wants to...
- How he wants to...

Listen to the words of Jesus. John 3:8 (KJV)
“The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.”

When we allow Holy Spirit to fill us, He enthrones God in our lives. When God is enthroned within us, the Spirit will have the freedom to reign, just as the wind blows where it chooses to blow.

III. FIRE...

Fire represents a process of purity (gold, silver, new life springs from the ground after

a fire – Christmas Eve fire).

Acts 2:1-4 (KJV) *"And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. ² And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. ³ And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. ⁴ And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance."*

Before Pentecost, the Disciples were a group of wishy-washy, up and down, in and out, spineless, gutless wonders; but after Pentecost *"They loved not their lives, even unto death."*

IV. OIL...

Oil is a lubricant. Take oil away from an engine and everything fails. (My experience with a Lincoln in the 80's – Oil pump failed – The whole car became inoperable)

Remove the oil of Holy Spirit from the church and it will never be anything more than another good social club. Sadly, this is what is happening to the modern-day Pentecostal Church. Ecumenicalism and the need to be accepted by the masses have all but neutered the Pentecostal church.

Oil carries with it a component of energy. The number one source of energy in the world today is oil. Luke 4:18-19 (NKJV)

***“The Spirit of the Lord is upon me,
because he hath anointed me to preach the
gospel to the poor; he hath sent me to heal
the brokenhearted, to preach deliverance to
the captives, and recovering of sight to the
blind, to set at liberty them that are bruised,***

¹⁹ To preach the acceptable year of the Lord.”

Jesus never performed one miracle until the Holy Spirit came upon Him in the form of a dove.

We should remember that Jesus did not do miracles as God, but as a man anointed of God, by Holy Spirit. If this is true, the same miracle working power resides in all who have received the baptism of the Holy Spirit.

CONCLUSION:

Ephesians 5:18 (KJV) ***“Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit.”*** Paul is telling the Ephesians to stop living under the intoxication of the world and its system.

He then takes it a step further to say that once you have disconnected yourself from the inebriation of the world, fill yourself up

with Holy Spirit, and live under the influence. (I hope we get so full of Holy spirit that we will need a designated driver – Buddy Crawford)

The word filled, as it is used here, is Pleroo (Play-row) and means to fill to the full. When I go to fill my vehicle up, I don't stop when the nozzle kicks off, I continue until I have topped the tank off.

I challenge every single person to be filled with Holy Spirit.

Those who have already been filled with Holy Spirit, could use a refilling tonight.